

Q) Recently, Canara Bank has launched 'Canara Crest' membership program, a first-of-its-kind initiative led by the bank, offering a personalized and premium banking experience to cater the evolving needs of _____.

- A. Elders
- B. High-Net-Worth Individuals (HNWI)
- C. Retail Investors
- D. Startups

Answer: B. High-Net-Worth Individuals (HNWI)

- **About Canara Crest Program:**

- The program will offer **exclusive benefits** to its eligible customers like: **service lounge access, dining rewards, exclusive hotel stays, unlimited fitness memberships, and more.**
- The program is **structured into two different segments: CREST and CREST PLUS.**
 - **Membership for 'CREST' segment** is available for **customers who maintain Quarterly Average Balance (QAB) of Rs 10 lakh to Rs 50 lakh.**
 - **Membership for 'CREST PLUS' segment** is available for customers who maintain Quarterly Average Balance (QAB) of **Rs 50 lakh and above.**
- The **Zero Cost membership** is available in **two scenarios i.e. either by invitation for eligible existing customers or through the opening of a new saving account** under the Canara CREST segment. **No Minimum Balance Maintenance Charges.**



Q) Recently, Finvasia has partnered with which of the following banks to launch 'Jumpp', an Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled super application (app) to simplify personal finance?

- A. Axis Bank
- B. Federal Bank
- C. IndusInd Bank
- D. YES Bank

Answer: D. YES Bank

Q) Recently, which of the following banks has become a signatory of the **Partnership for Carbon Accounting Financials (PCAF)**?

- A. Indian Overseas Bank (IOB)
- B. Punjab and Sind Bank
- C. Bank of India
- D. Central Bank of India

Answer: A. Indian Overseas Bank (IOB)

Q) Recently, _____ has extended Rs 2,000 crore loan to Gramercy Techpark Private Limited for setting up of 120-MegaWatt (MW) data centre at **Mahape in Navi Mumbai**, Maharashtra.

- A. Asian Development Bank (ADB)
- B. New Development Bank (NDB)
- C. National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development (NaBFID)
- D. World Bank

Answer: C. National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development (NaBFID)

Q) Recently, which of the following companies has launched '**Knowledgeable AI**' (KAI), an AI-powered virtual home loan advisor on its newly redesigned corporate website?

- A. L&T Finance Limited
- B. Mahindra & Mahindra Financial Services Limited
- C. Muthoot Finance Ltd
- D. Bajaj Finance

Answer: A. L&T Finance Limited

Q) Recently, **Tata Power Renewable Energy Limited (TPREL)** has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with which of the following banks to offer loans for Residential Rooftop Solar Installations?

- A. Bank of Baroda
- C. Canara Bank

- B. Union Bank of India
- D. ICICI Bank



Answer: A. Bank of Baroda

Q) Recently, Reserve Bank of India has formed a working group to review **trading and settlement timing** of financial markets regulated by Reserve Bank of India (RBI). Who among the following has been appointed as head of this committee?

- A. Aviral Jain
- C. R Lakshmi Kanth Rao

- B. Radha Shyam Ratho
- D. Vivek Deep

Answer: B. Radha Shyam Ratho

Other Information

- In a significant move to enhance **digital payment security**, the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has announced the implementation of **Additional Factor Authentication (AFA)** for **cross-border “Card Not Present” (CNP) transactions**.
 - This initiative aims to **secure international transactions** using **Indian-issued cards**, ensuring they are as **safe and fraud-proof** as domestic transactions.
 - With the increasing volume of **online shopping** and a rising number of **fraudulent activities**, this **new security measure** is expected to **strengthen consumer protection** and improve trust in **international digital transactions**.
 - **Note:** A **card-not-present (CNP) transaction** is a **purchase made without the cardholder physically presenting their card** at the **time of payment**. CNP transactions can occur **online, by phone, by mail, or by fax**.

Q) Recently, which of the following companies has announced the launch of ‘**HERizon Care**’, a new health insurance product designed exclusively to cater evolving healthcare requirements of women?

- A. Aditya Birla Health Insurance
- C. Bajaj Allianz General Insurance Company Limited

- B. Niva Bupa Health Insurance Company Limited
- D. Reliance General Insurance Company Limited

Answer: C. Bajaj Allianz General Insurance Company Limited

- **Key Features:**
 - **Covers Expenses for Various treatment:** It is a **first-of-its-kind health insurance coverage** that provides coverage for **Infertility Treatment, Assisted Reproductive Technology & Maternity Expenses, Adoption expenses, Pre-natal Health (in-utero treatment), congenital disability cover, among others**.
 - It also **extends coverage for surrogate mothers, Oocyte donors** as well as to live-in partners.
 - It covers the **legal expenses for sexual assault, kidnapping and acid attacks**.
 - **Affordable Health Insurance Coverage:** It provides flexible and affordable plans with premium discounts for Human Papillomavirus (HPV) vaccination, **first-come-first-serve policy entry**.
 - **Eligibility Criteria:** Women aged **18 to 80 years** and children from **90 days to 35 years** are eligible to avail the benefits of this new health insurance product.
 - **Minimum and Maximum Health Insurance Coverage:** It offers **sum insured options ranging from Rs 3 lakhs to Rs 2 crores** to eligible women beneficiaries. It works on an individual sum insured basis with a policy time period of **1 to 5 years**, offering flexible payment options and lifelong renewal options
 - **Two Key Components of HERizon Care:**
 - HERizon Care includes **two key components namely, Vita Shield and Cradle Care**, along with range of optional covers to address specific healthcare requirements.



- **Vita Shield**, a critical Illness and Holistic Wellness Protection component, which offers protection against **34 critical illnesses**, covering both general and female-specific conditions.
 - In addition to it, this cover can be **improved with optional extensions to further support policy holders** such as: **loss of job; incidental expenses cover offers financial assistance** for essential medical expenses, including reconstructive surgery, physiotherapy, home nursing, among others.
 - It also includes a **holistic wellness ecosystem** that offers access to resources that prioritize physical and mental well-being such as: **community support, diet and nutrition consultations, and preventive health check-ups**, among others.
- **The Cradle Care**, provides women's **reproductive health coverage** which includes surrogate care, covering **medical expenses** for **surrogate mothers** during surrogacy pregnancy and post-partum recovery.
 - It will also cover **medical expenses for Oocyte donor** during inpatient hospitalization for any complications.

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

- **Aditya Birla Housing Finance Limited (ABHFL, Corp Office - Mumbai)**, a subsidiary of Aditya Birla Capital Limited, a financial services company, secured an investment of **Rs 830 crore** through **non-convertible debentures (NCDs)** from the **International Finance Corporation (IFC)**.
 - The investment aims to **improve financial inclusion (FI) and support communities** in the **affordable housing**.
 - The funding will be used to **provide housing loans to low- and middle-income groups**, with a focus on **promoting homeownership** among women.
 - Additionally, a **portion of the funds** will **support small and medium-sized businesses (MSMEs)**, particularly those **led by women**, to help foster economic growth
- **Mumbai (Maharashtra) based State Bank of India (SBI)** introduced a new Term Deposit (TD) Scheme called '**SBI Patrons**' for **Super Senior Citizens** (residents aged **80 years or above**).
 - The scheme is designed to **offer additional interest benefits**, with an **interest rate 10 basis points (0.10%) higher** than the rates offered to senior citizens.
 - The Scheme offers interest rates **from 4.10% to 7.60%** for super senior citizens.
 - The scheme offers **Term Deposit Receipt (TDR)** and **Short-Term Deposit Receipt (STDR)** with a minimum deposit of **Rs.1,000** and a maximum deposit of up to **Rs.3 crore**. The deposit tenure **ranges from 7 days to 10 years**.
 - SBI imposes a **penalty of 0.50%** for **premature withdrawals up to Rs.5 lakh**, and **1% for amounts exceeding Rs.5 lakh**.
- **Mumbai (Maharashtra) Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Company Limited (KMAMC)**, asset manager of Kotak Mutual Fund, launched **Kotak MSCI India Exchange-Traded Fund (ETF)**, **India's 1st ETF** designed to **track the Morgan Stanley Capital International (MSCI) India Index**.
 - The New Fund Offer (NFO) is opened from **January 29, 2025**, and will close on **February 12, 2025**. The scheme is scheduled to **reopen for continuous trading** on or before February 27, 2025.
 - The ETF is designed for **investors aiming for long-term capital growth**, especially those seeking exposure to the companies included in the MSCI India Index.
 - It offers **diversified exposure** across sectors like **consumer discretionary, finance, healthcare, and real estate**, providing a cost-effective way to invest in Indian equities.
 - The **minimum application amount** during the NFO is **Rs.5,000**, with the possibility of investing any amount thereafter and the cost to invest during the NFO is **Rs.10 per unit**, with no exit load.
 - **Note:** The MSCI India Index is a global benchmark that **includes 156 large and mid-cap companies**, covering about 85% of the Indian equity market
- **Bhupendra Patel, Chief Minister (CM) of Gujarat** launched **Sensex Future & Options (F&O) contracts** on the **India International Exchange (India INX)**, India's first international stock exchange platform and

subsidiary of Bombay Stock Exchange Limited (BSE) at Gujarat International Finance Tech-City- International Financial Services Centre (GIFT-IFSC) in Gandhinagar, Gujarat.



- This new offering will allow the **international investors** to **trade and settle BSE derivatives** in **United States Dollar (USD)**, facilitating greater **participation** from global traders and investors.
- This will also enable the global investors to **trade India's benchmark equity index without currency conversion risks**.
- The **minimum ticket size will be USD 1**. The **last Tuesday of the contract month** will be considered the **final settlement day** for the contract.
- The contracts will follow a **three-month trading cycle**, and settlements will be conducted in **cash, denominated in US dollars**.
- The contracts will trade for **22 hours per day**, which is in alignment with global markets and **expanding access to Indian equities** through tax friendly regime of GIFT City.
- **Note:** F&O derivatives are the financial derivatives that **permit traders to speculate on asset price movements without owning the asset itself**. It includes **underlying assets** such as **stocks, bonds, commodities**, among others.
- **About India International Exchange (India INX):**
 - It is **India's 1st international exchange established at GIFT City in 2017**. It offers global investors with a **wide range of investment opportunities** in a regulated, tax-efficient, and technologically advanced environment.
 - **Headquarters-** Gandhinagar, Gujarat
- Thrissur (Kerala)-based **South Indian Bank Limited (SIB)** has launched two new innovative startup Current Account (CA) products namely, '**SIB Business Startup Current Account**' and '**SIB Corporate Startup Current Account**'. This move aims to strengthen the startup ecosystem in India
 - **SIB Business Startup CA:** is designed exclusively for **sole proprietorships and partnerships**, offering **important banking services** which will help in establishing a strong foundation for new businesses.
 - **SIB Corporate Startup CA:** is designed to address the **more complex financial requirements of larger business entities** such as: private limited companies, public limited companies, one-person companies, and limited liability partnerships (LLPs).
 - **Eligibility:** In order to qualify for these accounts, businesses are required to be **incorporated or registered** within the **last 3 years**.
 - **Key features:** **Zero minimum balance requirements** for maximum 3 years; **unlimited free Real Time Gross Settlement (RTGS)/National Electronic Funds Transfer (NEFT) transactions** via digital channels, and premium debit cards with exclusive benefits like airport lounge access
- Jaipur (Rajasthan) based **121 Finance Private Limited**, India's 1st Reserve Bank of India (RBI) registered Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC) Factor **partnered with Government e-Marketplace (GeM)**, an initiative of the Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoC&I), along with Bengaluru (Karnataka) based **Perfios Software Solutions Private Limited** and Mumbai (Maharashtra) based **Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)** developed **GeM Sahay 2.0**.
 - GeM Sahay 2.0 aims to **enhance financial inclusion** by making the **platform more accessible and effective** for Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) while ensuring a seamless experience for lenders.
 - 121 Finance played a key role in the **pilot phase of GeM Sahay**, setting a **benchmark for digital lending** with its real-time, tech-driven financing, making the platform more accessible and effective for MSMEs.
 - This collaboration designs **specialized loan products** with small ticket sizes, serving as key partners in the Open Credit Enablement Network (OCEN) framework
 - The OCEN framework highlights how digital platforms can transform lending in India. Its scalability and flexibility will support more projects, fostering MSME growth and financial inclusion



- **Sharan Hegde's platform, The 1% Club (Mumbai)**, has made history by becoming **one of the first finfluencer-led companies** to secure the **SEBI Registered Investment Advisor (RIA) license**.
 - The licence allows an **individual or firm to operate as an RIA** that is **legally authorised** to provide **financial advice to clients on investments** in the **Indian market**, subject to specific regulations set by SEBI.
 - This achievement marks a significant step for the Indian financial advisory sector, where the presence of certified, regulated financial advisors has always been scarce.
 - With this new milestone, **The 1% Club** can now legally offer personalized financial advice and services, making it one of the most credible names in the growing **world of financial influencers or 'finfluencers.'**
 - **Entity Type:** The firm must be a **company or Limited Liability Partnership (LLP)**.
 - **Qualification:** **At least one director or partner** must have a **minimum of a graduate degree** in any discipline from a recognized university.
 - Additionally, **professional qualifications** like **Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA)** or **Master of Business Administration (MBA)** (with a specialization in finance) may be considered.
 - **Certification:** Individuals providing advisory services must have passed the National Institute of Securities Markets (NISM)-Series-X-A: Investment Adviser (Level 1) Examination.
 - **Net Worth:** The firm must have a minimum net worth of **Rs.25 lakh** to register as an RIA with the SEBI.
- **Beacon**, a fintech firm on financial services for immigrants in **Toronto (Canada)**, launched '**India Bill Pay**', a service that **allows Non-Resident Indians (NRIs) to pay bills directly in India** using **Canadian dollars** from their **Beacon Money** account through the **Beacon Money** application (app).
 - This **first-of-its-kind service** is designed to simplify **bill payments for immigrants**, in collaboration with **Bharat Connect** (formerly Bharat Bill Payment System, BBPS) and Mumbai (Maharashtra) based **YES Bank Limited**.
 - With this launch, Beacon becomes the **1st North American company to integrate with Bharat Connect**.
 - Beacon's India Bill Pay **enables NRIs to pay over 21,000 Indian billers, including utilities, loans, school fees, and hospital charges**.
 - This process is seamless, secure, and uses the Rupee Drawing Arrangement (**RDA**), regulated by the Reserve Bank of India (**RBI**).
 - The benefits include **100% digital Know Your Customer (KYC)** and **onboarding in 10 minutes, auto-fetch bill amounts** with timely payment reminders.
- Board of Directors (BoD) of **Mumbai (Maharashtra)-based General Insurance Corporation of India (GIC Re)** has approved the **setting-up of a wholly-owned subsidiary i.e. GIC Re, India Service Company in the United Kingdom (UK)**.
 - There is **no minimum capital requirement for the company** and can be set up with a **capital of Great Britain Pound (GBP) 1**, equivalent to **USD 1.24**.
 - Currently, GIC Re's group **includes subsidiary companies** such as GIC Re South Africa, GIC Re Corporate Member, London, and GIC Perestrakhovanie LLC, Moscow.
 - The company will seek **final approval** from the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (**IRDAI**) before making the investment.
 - **Note:** (GIC Re) is a **100% Government of India (GoI)-owned Public Sector Undertaking (PSU)** company. It has branch offices in **London (the UK)** and **Kuala Lumpur (Malaysia)**. It was incorporated on 22 November 1972 under Companies Act, 1956.
- **Mumbai (Maharashtra)-based Angel One Asset Management Company (AMC) Limited**, wholly-owned subsidiary of Angel One Limited, has launched two New Fund Offerings (NFOs) namely, **Angel One Nifty Total Market ETF**, which is India's 1st Exchange Traded Fund (ETF) and the **Angel One Nifty Total Market Index Fund**.
 - The funds are **passively managed**; aim to monitor the **performance of the Nifty Total Market Total Return Index (TRI)**, delivering a low-cost and efficient investment strategy.



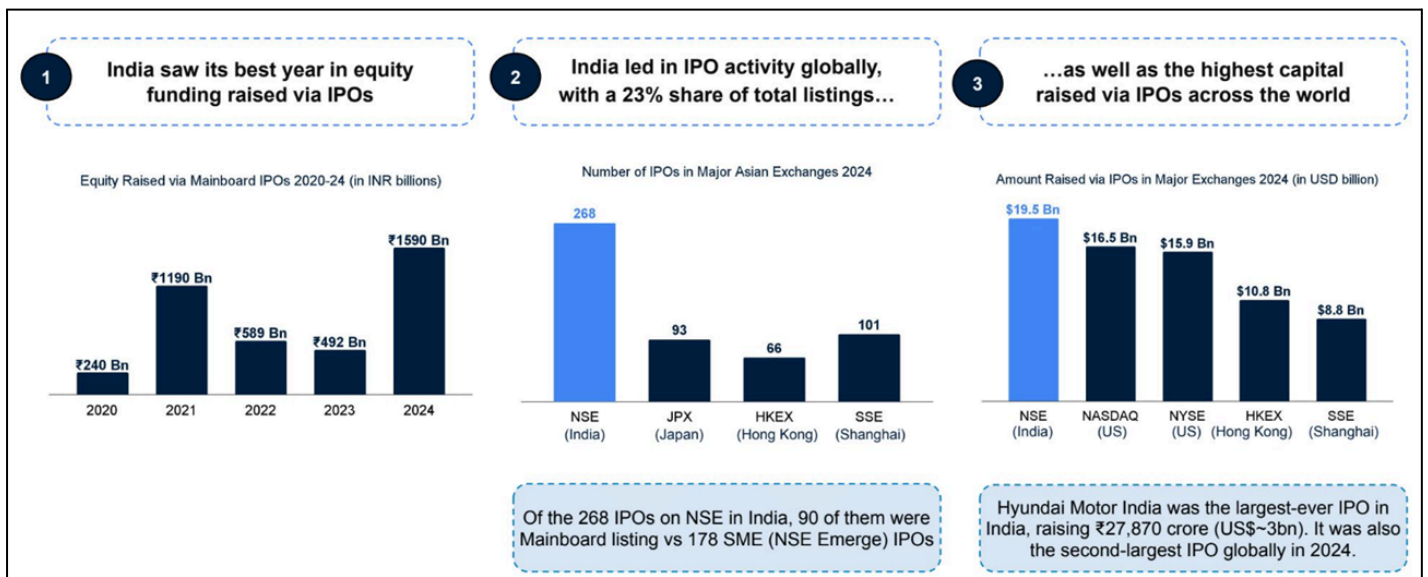
- Both these NFO of the scheme were opened on February 10 2025 for **subscription** and will **close** on **February 21, 2025**.
 - Both formats aim to **track 750 stocks** from the **Nifty 500** and **Nifty Microcap 250 indices across 22 sectors**, including large (60%), mid (19%), small (10%) and microcap segments (4%), accounting 93% of India's total market capitalization.
 - The NFO is **priced at Rs 10 per unit** with **no exit load**, and **minimum investment amount** will be **Rs 1,000** with subsequent investments allowed in multiples of **Re 1**.
 - Systematic Investment Plan (SIP) options are available in daily, weekly, fortnightly, monthly and quarterly basis for the index format.
 - **The fund will be available under both direct and regular plans, with a growth option.**
 - The Angel One AMC Limited has **appointed Mehul Dama**, who is currently serving Chief Investment Officer (CIO) of the company; and **Kewal Shah** as Fund Managers.
 - The scheme is an **open-ended ETF**, and **units of ETF** will be **listed on the National Stock Exchange Limited (NSE)** within **5 working days** after allotment
- **Maaza**, Coca-Cola (Atlanta, Georgia, United States)'s mango-based beverage, achieved a historic milestone in 2024 by surpassing **USD 1 billion in annual sales**.
 - This marks Maaza as Coca-Cola's **third billion-dollar brand** in India, following **Thums Up (2021)** and **Sprite (2022)**.
 - This positions Maaza as the **30th billion-dollar brand** for the **beverage globally**.
 - Maaza is one of India's most popular mango-flavored drinks, **originally launched by Parle Bisleri in 1976**.
 - In **1993**, **Coca-Cola acquired Maaza** along with other leading Indian beverage brands, including Thums Up, Limca, and Gold Spot.
 - In **2024**, The Coca-Cola Company reported **net gains of USD 13 million** in the December quarter and USD 303 million for the entire year through the refranchising of its bottling operations in India.

Q) India has accounted for 268 IPOs, with 90 mainboard listings and 178 SME listings, according to recently released '**Indus Valley Annual Report 2025**'. This report is released by which of the following companies?

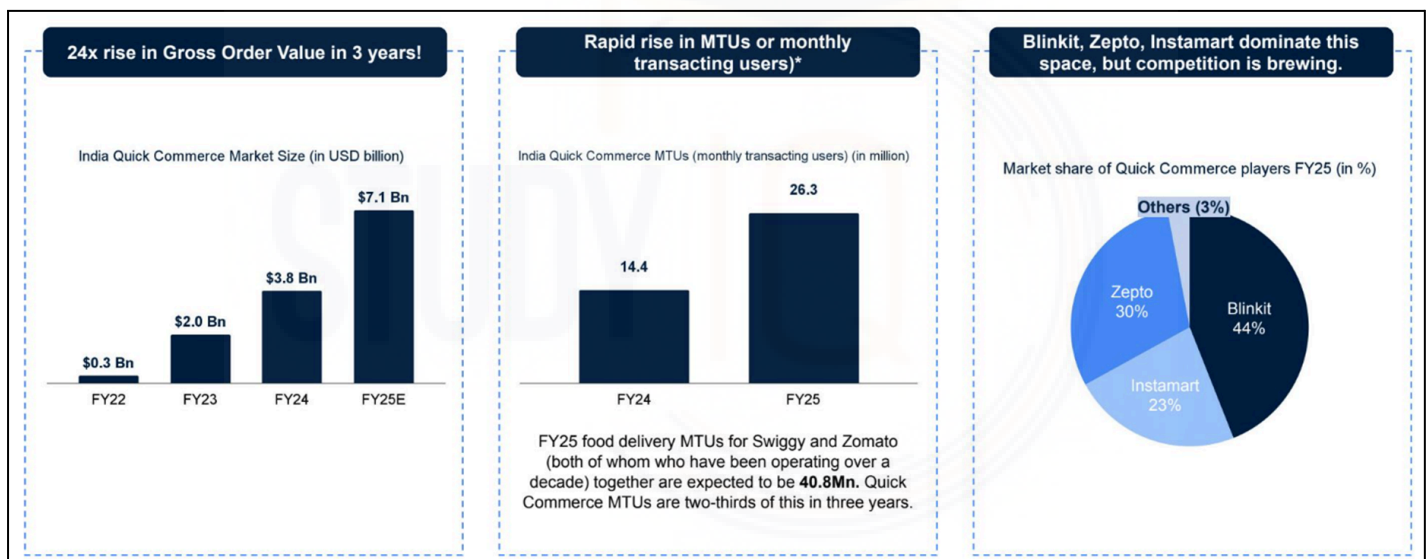
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| A. Blume Ventures | B. Accel |
| C. Matrix Partners | D. Chiratae Ventures |

Answer: A. Blume Ventures

- India accounted for **268 IPOs**, with **90 mainboard listings** and **178 SME listings**, according to **Indus Valley Annual Report 2025**.
- Additionally, India's IPOs also raised the **highest amount of money, at \$19.5 billion**, followed by US Nasdaq-listed IPOs, which raised **\$16.5 billion**, and US NYSE-listed IPOs which raised **\$15.9 billion**.
- The year also saw India's largest IPO, **Hyundai Motors' ₹27,870-crore fresh issue**, which was the **world's second largest IPO** too in 2024.
- However, the report added that the **median market capitalisation of firms** launching their IPO **dipped** for the third consecutive years in 2023, from ₹3,800 crore in 2021 to ₹3,000 crore in 2022 and ₹2,770 crore in 2023.
- **Venture funds** have also shown **renewed interest in Indian markets**, with the amount of money raised by venture-funded IPOs after 2021 rising to more than double the money raised by all venture-funded IPOs listed before 2021.
 - Some of the **venture capitalist-backed IPOs** include Nykaa, Delhivery, Zomato, Paytm, Swiggy, Policybazaar, MapmyIndia, Cafe Coffee Day, Just Dial, Quick Heal, Info Edge and Matrimony.com.
- Since 2012, the **median SME IPO market cap** has **jumped 4.5 times to nearly ₹100 crore** as of 2024 while the median revenue at IPO grew 3 times to nearly ₹70 crore.



- India's quick commerce market has grown **24 times** from \$300 million in FY22 to \$7.1 billion in FY25E.
- **Blinkit** commands the largest market share in the sector, at **44%**, followed by **Zepto** (30%) and **Swiggy Instamart** (23%).
- Blinkit is present across **85 cities** while Swiggy Instamart and Zepto are present in 77 and 71 cities respectively.
- The number of **dark stores** being operated by Blinkit has risen from **364 in FY23** to **1,251 in FY25E**.
- For **Swiggy Instamart**, the number has increased from 421 to 1,004 in the same time period while for Zepto, the number of stores have risen from 200 to 1,050.



Q) Recently, **Axis Bank** has committed ₹104 crore to which of the following universities to strengthen the university's PhD and Post-Doctoral programs while enhancing its research capabilities in Neurosciences, Behavioral Studies, and Physics?

- A. Ashoka University
C. Amity University

- B. Sharda University
D. Galgotias University



Answer: A. Ashoka University

Q) Recently, which of the following banks has celebrated its 101st Founders' Day, marked over a century of the bank's operations, by launching two new products '**Stri**' and '**One Family Banking Programme**'?

- A. Axis Bank
C. Karnataka Bank

- B. Federal Bank
D. RBL Bank

Answer: C. Karnataka Bank

- **KBL One Family Banking Programme**

- KBL One Family Banking Programme' is a **banking solution** that links the **family under one ID**, offering tailored benefits, shared privileges and seamless access.

- **About KBL Stri:**

- 'KBL Stri' is a **savings bank account** that enables **women** to **determine their success**, whether they are **homemakers, professionals, or entrepreneurs**.
- It has **two accounts** namely, **Signature account** and **Premium account**.

- **Signature Account:**

- The signature account requires a **monthly average balance of Rs 5,000**.
- It offers various benefits, including **one domestic lounge per quarter** with National Common Mobility Card (NCMC) RuPay Platinum Domestic Debit Card with free issuance.
- It also provides **personal accident insurance coverage** up to **Rs 2 lakh** and home shield insurance coverage of **Rs 10 lakh**.

- **Premium Account:**

- The premium account requires a **monthly average balance of Rs 25,000**.
- It offers a range of **exclusive benefits** like **one domestic lounge access per quarter** and **two international lounge accesses per year** with the NCMC RuPay Platinum International Debit Card with free issuance and Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC).
- The programme provides **personal accident insurance coverage** of up to **Rs 2 lakh** and home shield insurance coverage of **Rs 10 lakh**, ensuring financial security.
- The programme also includes **cancer indemnity coverage** of **Rs 25 lakh**, along with access to **health consultations** and **medical checkups**, including pap smear tests

Q) Recently, **SBI Cards and Payment Services Limited, SBICPSL (SBI Cards)**, a subsidiary of State Bank of India (SBI) has announced _____ as its new Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO).

- A. Abhijit Chakravorty
C. Salila Pande

- B. Prabdev Singh
D. Shahrukh Todiwala

Answer: C. Salila Pande

Recent Appointments

- **Standard Chartered** has announced the **appointment of Prabdev Singh** as its **chief executive officer (CEO)** for **India**, effective April 1. Singh will take over from **Zarin Daruwala**, who will retire on March 31.
 - Prior to Standard Chartered, Singh was the **CEO of JP Morgan Chase Bank in India**, where he played a pivotal role in shaping the bank's corporate banking franchise as a founding member.
 - **Standard Chartered India (Mumbai)** (officially **Standard Chartered Bank India Branches**) is a foreign branch of Standard Chartered, **incorporated in the London, United Kingdom** with limited liability.
- **Kotak Mahindra Prime**, a subsidiary of **Kotak Mahindra Bank (KMB, Mumbai)**, appointed **Shahrukh Todiwala** as the new MD, CEO of the company.
 - Todiwala **succeeds Vyomesh Kapasi**, who will now take over as the head of product-consumer bank vertical at KMB.

Q) Recently, which of the following companies has announced its latest strategic financing collaboration with **Financierings-Maatschappij voor Ontwikkelingslanden N.V. (FMO)**, the Dutch entrepreneurial development bank to promote economic and social development in India?

- A. Bajaj Finance Limited
C. Mahindra & Mahindra Financial Services Limited

- B. UGRO Capital Limited
D. Aditya Birla Finance Limited

Answer: B. UGRO Capital Limited

Q) Recently, which of the following companies has partnered with **Eurobank S.A.** for a multi-year banking technology programme to enhance customer experience, simplify operations, and develop creative Information Technology (IT) solutions for Eurobank and its subsidiaries?

- A. Wipro
- C. Infosys

- B. LTI Mindtree Ltd
- D. HCLTech



Answer: B. LTI Mindtree Ltd

Q) Recently, which of the following banks has announced its partnership with the **Professional Golf Tour of India (PGTI)** as its official Banking Partner?

- A. Axis Bank
- C. IndusInd Bank

- B. Federal Bank
- D. YES Bank

Answer: C. IndusInd Bank

Q) Recently, which of the following companies has introduced **Bima-Application Supported by Blocked Amount (Bima-ASBA)** facility, making it the first insurer in India to adopt this new payment method?

- A. HDFC Life Insurance Company Limited
- C. Max Life Insurance Company Limited

- B. Bajaj Allianz Life Insurance Company
- D. Reliance Nippon Life Insurance Company Limited

Answer: B. Bajaj Allianz Life Insurance Company

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

- **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)** organised the **9th edition of Bima Manthan held in Hyderabad (Telangana)**, its a quarterly meeting with insurance company Chief Executive Officers (CEOs).
 - During the meeting, IRDAI has introduced the '**Bima Trinity**' initiative to enhance the **accessibility, affordability, and efficiency of insurance services** in India.
 - This comprehensive plan **comprises three key components**: Bima Sugam, Bima Vistaar and Bima Vahaak.
 - The aim is to enhance **insurance inclusion and digital transformation**, reinforcing its commitment to a more **accessible and consumer-friendly insurance ecosystem** as part of its Vision Insurance for all' by 2047.
 - **Highlights:**
 - **Bima Sugam**: An open **digital marketplace** designed to **facilitate the sale, servicing, and claims of insurance policies** across various insurance companies.
 - **Bima Vistaar**: A pioneering **composite insurance product** that **offers coverage for life, personal accidents, property, and surgical hospitalization**.
 - **Bima Vahaak**: A **localized, women-centric insurance field sales force** aimed at enhancing insurance penetration in underserved areas. Bima Vahaak is scheduled for a soft launch in April 2025.

Q) Recently, which of the following banks has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with **Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP)** to provide special financial benefits and insurance coverage for ITBP personnel, pensioners and their families?

- A. Canara Bank
- C. Punjab National Bank (PNB)

- B. State Bank of India (SBI)
- D. Bank of India

Answer: C. Punjab National Bank (PNB)

- **Key Benefits for ITBP Personnel:**
 - Under the partnership, ITBP personnel will receive the following benefits:



- **Personal Accidental Insurance (PAI):** Rs. 100 lakhs
- **Air Accidental Insurance (AAI):** Rs. 150 lakhs
- **Permanent/Partial Disability Coverage:** Rs. 100 lakhs
- **Additional Cover for Death During Operations:** Rs. 10 lakhs
- **Cost of Imported Medicines (including transportation):** Up to Rs. 10 lakhs
- **Air Ambulance Cost:** Up to Rs. 10 lakhs

○ **Other Benefits:**

- PNB has extended its **Rakshak Account benefits** to **ITBP pensioners** who are receiving Pension from PNB, providing them with lifetime PAI coverage of **Rs. 50 lakhs** and AAI coverage of **Rs. 100 lakhs**
- PNB has shown its commitment to **supporting India's armed forces**, especially the 'Himveers' (Personnel) of ITBP, by providing tailored financial products and services

Q) Recently, which of the following banks has hosted 9th edition of **Evolve**, its flagship knowledge-sharing seminar for Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) in Bengaluru, Karnataka?

- A. Axis Bank
B. Federal Bank
C. IndusInd Bank
D. YES Bank

Answer: A. Axis Bank

- The event focused on the **theme 'Future-Proofing MSMEs for the New-Age Business'** emphasized the significance of **digital transformation, innovation, and operational resilience for MSMEs** in a changing business landscape.
- This year **2025**, the initiative is being **hosted in 10 key cities**, including New Delhi (Delhi), Mumbai (Maharashtra), Lucknow (Uttar Pradesh, UP), Kolkata (West Bengal, WB), Chennai (Tamil Nadu, TN), Hyderabad (Telangana), Bengaluru (Karnataka), Kochi (Kerala), Indore (Madhya Pradesh, MP) and Ahmedabad (Gujarat).

Q) Recently, which of the following companies in partnership with **K.M. Dastur Reinsurance Brokers (KMD)**, launched one of India's first Air Quality Index (AQI)-based parametric insurance policies for migrant labourers affected by construction bans during periods of high air pollution in the Delhi National Capital Region (NCR) region?

- A. Aditya Birla Health Insurance
B. Niva Bupa Health Insurance Company Limited
C. Bajaj Allianz General Insurance Company Limited
D. Go Digit General Insurance Limited

Answer: D. Go Digit General Insurance Limited

Q) Recently, which of the following banks has launched India's first Public Sector Undertaking (PSU) Salary Account with a cyber fraud protection '**Anmol Savings Account**'?

- A. Canara Bank
B. State Bank of India (SBI)
C. HDFC Bank
D. Bank of India

Answer: C. HDFC Bank

- Mumbai (Maharashtra) based **HDFC Bank Limited**, India's leading private sector bank, launched **India's first Public Sector Undertaking (PSU) Salary Account** with a **cyber fraud protection 'Anmol Savings Account'**.
- As a part of the '**Speciale**' suite of savings accounts, caters to a variety of clients, including **women, working professionals, and senior citizens**.
- HDFC Bank provides **cyber fraud cover up to Rs. 1.5 lakhs** to **senior citizens** while the cyber fraud cover ranges from **Rs. 25,000-Rs 50,000 for professionals**. Similarly, the '**Speciale Gold Women**' account gives a cancer cover of up to **Rs. 5 lakhs for women**.
- **Key Features of Anmol Savings Account:**
 - **Cyber Fraud Protection:** It covers **up to Rs 25,000** for account holders.



- **Family Benefits:** It allows up to **five family members** to **open zero-balance salary accounts**.
- **Insurance Coverage:** It includes a **health insurance plan** with **Outpatient Department (OPD) benefits**, **accident insurance of Rs 15 lakh**, and **top-up plans of up to Rs 30 lakh**.
- **Loan Benefits:** It offers **additional home loans** beyond company-set limits for Maharatna PSU employees.
- **Exclusive Debit Card:** It comes with a **free Platinum Debit Card**, including eight complimentary domestic airport lounge visits per year

Q) Recently, Microfinance Institution Network (MFIN) India has released **52nd edition of Micrometer as on 31 December 2025 report**. The report showed that the total loan portfolio in the micro-finance sector has decreased by 3.5% Year-on-Year (Y-o-Y) to _____ during Q3FY25.

- A. Rs 3.15 trillion
B. Rs 4.35 trillion
C. Rs 3.85 trillion
D. Rs 4.07 trillion

Answer: C. Rs 3.85 trillion

- The report revealed that **disbursement of microfinance loans** has decreased **35.8% to Rs 22,091 crore** during the **3rd Quarter** (Q3: October-December) of **Financial Year 2024-25 (FY25)** compared with the year-ago period.
- The **Gross Loan Portfolio (GLP)** of the sector as of December 31, 2024, stood at **Rs 3,85,348 crore**.
- The report showed that the **total loan portfolio** in the micro-finance sector has decreased by **3.5% Year-on-Year (Y-o-Y) to Rs 3.85 trillion** during Q3FY25.
- Also, the **number of new loans** disbursed registered a **negative growth of 29.02%**.
- **Key Findings:**
 - As on December 31 2024, the **Assets Under Management (AUM)** of the MFIs stood at **Rs 1,42,695 crore**, reflecting a decrease of 0.1% against Q3FY24 and 6.5% on a sequential basis.
 - As per the report, the **average loan amount disbursed per account** during Q3FY25 was **Rs 51,691 crore**, showing an increase of **15.2%** compared to the same quarter of FY24.
 - Also, the **number of loan accounts for the sector** decreased from **146 million** (in Q3FY24) to **139 million** (in Q3FY25).
 - The report revealed that **Portfolio At Risk (PAR)**, defined as **unpaid loans of more than 30 days**, has **decreased to 8.8%** as on **December 31, 2024**, as **against 3.5% registered** with the year ago-period.
 - MFIN data further showed that **PAR has increased from 2%** (in Q3FY24) to **6.4% (Q3FY25)**.
 - The report showed that Non-Banking Finance Companies working as Microfinance Institutions (NBFC-MFIs) received **Rs 12,921 crore** in debt funding quarter under review, decrease from 40% Year-on-Year (Y-o-Y).
 - NBFC-MFIs received **maximum funding from banks** contributed **79%** of the total borrowing, followed by External Commercial Borrowing (**ECB**) (8%) and all India Financial Institutions (FIs) (4.3%).
- **Other Key Points:**
 - As per the report, the **loan portfolio of NBFC-MFIs decreased** by 3.8% Y-o-Y, banks (5.5%) and Small Finance Banks (SFBs) (11%).
 - In contrast to the above Financial Institutions (FI), NBFCs registered a growth of 22.2% in loans.
 - The report highlighted that the **loan amount disbursed** has reduced by 20% Y-o-Y, from Rs 78,584 (in Q3FY24) to **Rs 62,817 crore (in Q3FY25)**.
 - The report showed that in terms of **geographical coverage**, East and North-East and South regions cumulatively account **63%** of the total microfinance portfolio.
 - The **average loan size** has increased to **Rs 53,350 (in December 2024)** compared to **Rs 47,374** registered in December 2023 and **Rs 50,487** in September 2024.

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

- **Decentro Tech Private Limited (Reg Add – Gurugram)**, a leading fintech infrastructure platform, has launched **India's 1st** completely compliant, self-hosted Central Know Your Customer (CKYC) solution.
 - Central Know Your Customer (CKYC) is a **centralised registry** established to **store and manage KYC (Know Your Customer) documents** for **individuals** using financial services.
 - This will enable **financial institutions** to seamlessly **switch to the new Central Registry of Securitisation Asset Reconstruction and Security Interest of India (CERSAI)** compliance framework.
 - This new offering will **remove the dependency on 3rd-parties**, allowing **banks, Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)**, and **insurers** to **onboard customers faster** while ensuring regulatory compliance.
 - Some of the **key benefits** of this new innovation are: **80% faster processing**; **75% lower compliance costs**, and **zero vendor dependencies**.
- **About CERSAI:**
 - CERSAI is a Government of India company, **licensed under section 8 of the Companies Act, 2013**. Its Registered Office is at **New Delhi**.
 - The company has been incorporated with **majority shareholding of the Central Government, Public Sector Banks and National Housing Bank** initially for the purpose of operating a Registration System under the provisions of Chapter IV of the **Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (SARFAESI Act)**.
 - Later, CERSAI was entrusted upon the responsibility of **operating and maintaining a KYC Registry**, governed under PML Rules 2005 (Maintenance of Records).
- **GIFT City (Gandhinagar, Gujarat)** based **Gujarat International Finance Tec-City Company Limited (GIFTCL)**, the global financial services hub, partnered with **Hyderabad (Telangana)** based **Zaggle Prepaid Ocean Services Limited (ZPOSL)**, leading Business-to-Business Software-as-a-Service (B2B SaaS) FinTech company to **launch a co-branded Prepaid Citizen Card and Visitor Management System (VMS)**.
 - GIFTCL and ZPOSL have a **five-year agreement**, with possible extensions dependent on future requirements.
 - Prepaid Citizen cards are **accepted anywhere** in India and provide **easy, cashless transactions** for all **necessary services** within **GIFT City's premises**.
 - It will be a **safe digital identity and payment method** for everyone in GIFT City, which has a growing population and many workers from different companies.
 - VMS will **track, verify, and regulate visitor access**, ensuring **enhanced security** in the Special Economic Zone (SEZ) area.
 - VMS will integrate **identity verification, visitor pre-registration, and a simplified check-in/check-out process**, allowing only authorized individuals to enter the premises



Q) Recently, 55th Annual Meeting of **World Economic Forum (WEF 2025)** was held at which of the following places?

- | | |
|--------------------------------|--------------------|
| A. Davos-Klosters, Switzerland | B. Tokyo, Japan |
| C. Paris, France | D. Berlin, Germany |

Answer: A. Davos-Klosters, Switzerland

- **WEF 2025's theme: "Collaboration for the Intelligent Age"**

Q) Recently, **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** has developed a web-based portal for submission of preliminary and final root cause analysis (RCA) reports of technical glitches by stock exchanges and other market infrastructure institutions (MIIs). What is its name?

- | | |
|--------------|---------------|
| A. MII-Track | B. iSPOT |
| C. TechSpot | D. i TechLens |

Answer: B. iSPOT

- **Integrated SEBI Portal for Technical Glitches (iSPOT)**

Q) As per recent information, the **Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) digital payments index (DPI)** rose to _____ as of September 2024, compared to 445.5 in March 2024, reflecting the rapid adoption of digital payments in the country.

A. 455.23

B. 465.33

C. 475.13

D. 485.34



Answer: B. 465.33

- **About Digital Payments Index (DPI):**

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has constructed a **composite Digital Payments Index (DPI)** to **capture the extent of** digitisation of payments across the country.
- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has been publishing a composite Reserve Bank of India – **Digital Payments Index (RBI-DPI)** since **January 1, 2021** with March 2018 as base to capture the extent of digitisation of payments across the country.
- The RBI-DPI has been constructed with **March 2018 as the base period**, i.e., the **DPI score for March 2018 is set at 100**.
- The **DPI index** comprises **five broad parameters** that enable the measurement of deepening and penetration of digital payments in the country over different time periods. The parameters include:
 - **Payment enablers** (25 per cent weightage in the index)
 - **Demand-side and supply-side payment infrastructure factors** (10 per cent each)
 - **Payment performance** (45 per cent)
 - **Consumer centricity** (5 per cent)
 - **Each of the parameters has sub-parameters**, which, in turn, consist of various measurable indicators.

Q) Recently, **Reliance Jio Infocomm Ltd** has announced a free for life “_____” feature which provides sound alerts for UPI payments received.

A. JioSoundPay

B. JioTonePay

C. JioUPIPay

D. JioMoneyPay

Answer: A. JioSoundPay

Q) Recently, Government of India has approved introduction of **Mutual Credit Guarantee Scheme for MSMEs (MCGS-MSME)** for providing _____ guarantee coverage by National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company Limited (NCGTC) to Member Lending Institutions (MLIs*).

A. 40%

B. 50%

C. 60%

D. 35%

Answer: C. 60%

Q) As per recent information, _____ is set to launch “**when-listed**” platform, which is aimed at reducing the activity in the grey market, which is largely unregulated and has a significant influence on listings.

A. Reserve Bank of India (RBI)

B. National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE)

C. Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)

D. BSE Limited

Answer: C. Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)

Q) Recently, **Software Product Industry Round Table (iSPIRT)** has launched Priority Sector Lenders Association of India (PSLAI) to streamline and enhance the availability of loans under Priority Sector Lending (PSL) norms. PSLAI will be headed by _____ as Chief Executive Officer (CEO).

- A. Swati Gupta
C. Rishabh Garg

- B. Priyashmita Guha
D. Alisha Tarika Kapoor



Answer: B. Priyashmita Guha

Q) Recently, Ministry of Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MoMSME) in partnership with Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC) has announced the launch of “**MSME Trade Enablement and Marketing (TEAM) Initiative**” to enable small and micro enterprises to join ONDC. The initiative has a budget of ₹277.35 crore for a period of how many years?

- A. 2 years
C. 4 years

- B. 3 years
D. 5 years

Answer: B. 3 years

Q) Recently, Fintech platforms MobiKwik and _____ have rolled out an e₹ wallet for users on the platforms becoming the **first non-banks** to offer the central bank digital currency (CBDC).

- A. Cred
C. Perfios

- B. Zerodha
D. Slice

Answer: A. Cred

Q) Recently, **National Stock Exchange (NSE)** has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with which of the following states to implement a student skill-building program for the youth of the state in the banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI) sector?

- A. Odisha
C. Bihar

- B. Chhattisgarh
D. Uttar Pradesh

Answer: B. Chhattisgarh

Q) Recently released ‘**Centre for the Fourth Industrial Revolution Network 2023-2024 report**’ highlights powerful initiatives, such as artificial intelligence (AI)-driven decision-making tools in Rwanda, drones delivering healthcare in India and alternative proteins addressing food insecurity in Israel. This report has been released by _____.

- A. Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)
C. World Economic Forum (WEF)

- B. United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)
D. International Monetary Fund (IMF)

Answer: C. World Economic Forum (WEF)

Q) As per recently released **Union Budget 2025-26**, Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) limit for the insurance sector will be raised from _____ to 100 per cent.

- A. 49 per cent
C. 74 per cent

- B. 51 per cent
D. 33 per cent

Answer: C. 74 per cent



Q) According to recently released **State Bank of India (SBI's) Economic Research Department (ERD) report**, new investment announcements in India surged by _____ Year-on-Year (Y-o-Y), to over Rs 32 lakh crore in the first 9 Months (April –December) of Financial Year 2024-25 (9MFY25) from same period in the last year.

- A. 43%
C. 23%

- B. 39%
D. 34%

Answer: B. 39%

Q) Recently, which of the following organizations has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the **Tiruchirapalli District Tiny & Small-Scale Industries Association (TIDITSSIA)** to foster mutual cooperation and support local industries?

- A. Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce & Industry (FICCI) B. Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)
C. Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) D. Confederation of Indian Industry (CII)

Answer: B. Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)

Q) Recently, **Horst Koehler** has passed away. He served as the President of which of the following countries?

- A. Australia B. Canada
C. Russia D. Germany

Answer: D. Germany

Q) According to the list of **Top 10 powerful countries in the world 2025**, recently released by an American business magazine Forbes, the United States of America (USA) has secured the top spot as the most powerful country in the world with a Gross Domestic Product (GDP) of USD 30.34 trillion. Which of the following countries ranks second after the USA?

- A. India B. China
C. Russia D. Japan

Answer: B. China

- The USA was followed by **China** in the **2nd spot with a GDP of USD 19.53 trillion** and **Russia** in the **3rd position with a GDP of USD 2.2 trillion** respectively.
- **India** secured the **12th** position with a **GDP of USD 4.27 trillion** in the list as of February 2025.
- **Note:** In terms of **global GDP**, **India** is positioned at the **5th spot behind the USA, China, Germany, and Japan**.

Q) Recently, _____ has been announced as the first partner for X Corp (formerly known as Twitter, Inc.) in its upcoming **"X Money Account" service**, which is expected to launch in 2025.

- A. PayPal B. Mastercard
C. VISA D. American Express

Answer: C. VISA

Q) As per recent released **Union Budget 2025-26**, limit for tax deduction on interest for senior citizens has been proposed to be increased from the present Rs. 50,000 to _____.

- A. Rs. 3 lakh B. Rs. 2.5 lakh
C. Rs. 2 lakh D. Rs. 1 lakh

Answer: D. Rs. 1 lakh

Rationalizing TDS / TCS	Tax Reforms to Improve Ease of Doing Business
<i>Number of rates and thresholds above which TDS is deducted to be reduced</i>	
▶ Limit for tax deduction on interest for senior citizens to be doubled from ₹ 50,000 to ₹ 1 lakh ▶ Annual limit for TDS on rent to be increased from ₹ 2.40 lakh to ₹ 6 lakh ▶ Threshold to collect tax at source on remittances under RBI's Liberalized Remittance Scheme to be raised from ₹ 7 lakh to ₹ 10 lakh ▶ Only TDS and not TCS to be levied in goods sale transactions	▶ Scheme to be introduced for determining arm's length price of international transaction for a block period of three years ▶ Scope of safe harbour rules to be expanded, to reduce litigation and provide certainty in international taxation ▶ Tax exemption to be provided on withdrawals made from National Savings Scheme by individuals on or after 29th August, 2024



Zero Income Tax till ₹ 12 Lakh Income under New Tax Regime

Personal Income Tax Reforms with Special Focus on Middle Class

- ▶ 'Nil tax' for annual income up to ₹ 12.00 lakh (₹ 12.75 lakh for salaried tax payers with standard deduction of ₹ 75,000)
- ▶ New structure to substantially reduce taxes of middle class and leave more money in their hands, boosting household consumption, savings and investment
- ▶ Slabs and rates being changed across the board to benefit all tax-payers

0-4 lakh rupees	Nil
4-8 lakh rupees	5%
8-12 lakh rupees	10%
12-16 lakh rupees	15%
16-20 lakh rupees	20%
20-24 lakh rupees	25%
Above 24 lakh rupees	30%



Q) Recently, Kerala government has approved the **Kerala Health System Improvement Programme** after securing a Rs 2,424.28 crore loan from which of the following International organisation?

- A. Asian Development Bank (ADB) B. World Bank
C. International Monetary Fund (IMF) D. New Development Bank (NDB)

Answer: B. World Bank

Q) As per recent information, what is the revised repo rate as per the sixth and the last bi-monthly **Monetary Policy Committee (MPC)** meeting of Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for FY25?

- A. 6.25% B. 6.50%
C. 6.75% D. 6.00%

Answer: A. 6.25%

- **CRR stands for Cash Reserve Ratio and SLR stands for Statutory Liquidity Ratio.**

Policy Repo Rate	: 6.25%
Standing Deposit Facility Rate	: 6.00%
Marginal Standing Facility Rate	: 6.50%
Bank Rate	: 6.50%
Fixed Reverse Repo Rate	: 3.35%

Reserve Ratios	
CRR	: 4.00%
SLR	: 18.00%

RBI projects FY26 GDP growth at 6.7%; Here are quarterly estimates:

- FY26 at 6.7%
- Q1FY26 at 6.7%
- Q2FY26 at 7.0%
- Q3FY26 at 6.5%
- Q4FY26 at 6.5%

CPI inflation for FY25 is projected at 4.8% with Q4FY25 at 4.4%

CPI inflation for FY26 is projected at 4.2%; Here are quarterly projections:

- Q1FY26 at 4.5%
- Q2FY26 at 4.0%
- Q3FY26 at 3.8%
- Q4FY26 at 4.2%

Q) As per recently released Union Budget 2025-26, Centre will target **fiscal deficit** of _____ of the gross domestic product (GDP) for the financial year 2025-26, down from a revised 4.8 per cent for the current year.

- A. 4.0 per cent B. 4.2 per cent
C. 4.4 per cent D. 4.6 per cent

Answer: C. 4.4 per cent

Q) As per recent information, **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** is introducing exclusive internet domains for financial sector participants, including banking and non-banking entities. Registrations for these domains will commence from April 2025. _____ will serve as the exclusive registrar.

- A. National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) B. Indian Financial Technology and Allied Services (IFTAS)
C. Institute for Development and Research in Banking Technology (IDRBT) D. Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)

Answer: C. Institute for Development and Research in Banking Technology (IDRBT)

Q) Recently, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI), Government of India has celebrated the _____ anniversary of the **National Sample Survey (NSS)** at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi.

- A. 50th B. 75th
C. 85th D. 100th

Answer: B. 75th

Q) Recently, United States (US) has imposed tariffs on imports from China, Canada and Mexico as part of **Beggar-thy-neighbour policy**. The term beggar-thy-neighbour is attributed to the philosopher and economist _____, who first used it in his well-known 1776 book The Wealth of Nations.

- A. Friedrich Hayek B. Karl Marx
C. Alfred Marshall D. Adam Smith

Answer: D. Adam Smith

Q) As per recently released, Bloomberg Limited Partnership (LP)'s '**Asia's Richest Families 2025**' Index, the Ambani family of Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) (India) has secured the top position as Asia's richest family, with a net worth of USD 90.5 billion. Which of the following families has ranked second in the index?

- A. Hartono family B. Chearavanont family
C. Mistry Family D. Bajaj family

Answer: B. Chearavanont family

1		NAME Ambani	COMPANY Reliance Industries	WEALTH 90.5bn
		INDUSTRY Conglomerate	LOCATION India	GENERATIONS 3
2		NAME Chearavanont	COMPANY Charoen Pokphand Group	WEALTH 42.6bn
		INDUSTRY Conglomerate	LOCATION Thailand	GENERATIONS 4
3		NAME Hartono	COMPANY Djarum, Bank Central Asia	WEALTH 42.2bn
		INDUSTRY Tobacco, Finance	LOCATION Indonesia	GENERATIONS 3
4		NAME Mistry	COMPANY Shapoorji Pallonji Group	WEALTH 37.5bn
		INDUSTRY Conglomerate	LOCATION India	GENERATIONS 5



- Among the prominent 6 Indian families featured in the top 20 rankings list, the Mistry family holds the **4th** position, followed by the Jindal family in **7th place**, the Birla family ranks **9th**, the Bajaj family secures the **13th spot** and Hinduja family ranks **18th position**

7		NAME Jindal	COMPANY OP Jindal Group	WEALTH 28.1bn
		INDUSTRY Industrial	LOCATION India	GENERATIONS 3
9		NAME Birla	COMPANY Aditya Birla Group	WEALTH 23.0bn
		INDUSTRY Conglomerate	LOCATION India	GENERATIONS 7
13		NAME Bajaj	COMPANY Bajaj Group	WEALTH 20.1bn
		INDUSTRY Conglomerate	LOCATION India	GENERATIONS 4
18		NAME Hinduja	COMPANY Hinduja Group	WEALTH 15.2bn
		INDUSTRY Finance, Property	LOCATION India	GENERATIONS 4



Q) Recently, Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has launched a new digital platform, “MITRA” to help investors in tracking and reclaiming inactive or unclaimed Mutual Fund (MF) folios. In the acronym ‘MITRA,’ what does the letter “T” stand for?

- A. Transfer
C. Tracing
B. Tracking
D. Transparency

Answer: C. Tracing

- **Mutual Fund Investment Tracing and Retrieval Assistant (MITRA)**

Q) Recently, Union Finance Minister has presented the new **Income-Tax Bill 2025** in Lok Sabha, which aims to replace the Income Tax Act of 1961. The concept of an "assessment year" has been removed, with the term "previous year" now referred to as "_____".

- A. Business Year
C. Tax Year
B. Accounting Year
D. Revenue Year

Answer: C. Tax Year

Q) Recently, India and the European Free Trade Association (EFTA) have launched the **India-EFTA Desk** to strengthen economic ties and facilitate investments under the Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA). India-EFTA Desk is a dedicated investment facilitation mechanism established by _____ to serve as a single-window platform for businesses from the EFTA nations to invest in India.

- A. Invest India
C. India Trade Promotion Organisation (ITPO)
B. Indian Chamber of Commerce (ICC)
D. Confederation of Indian Industry (CII)

Answer: A. Invest India

Q) Recently, who among the following has been elected as 73rd President of **Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI)**?

- A. Charanjot Singh Nanda
C. Prasanna Kumar D
B. Ranjeet Kumar Agarwal
D. Dhananjay Shukla

Answer: A. Charanjot Singh Nanda

Q) Recently, _____ has launched a dedicated portal for **Related Party Transactions (RPT)** to enhance corporate governance and ensure better transparency in the Indian securities market.

- A. Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
- B. National Stock Exchange of India Ltd
- C. BSE Limited
- D. Reserve Bank of India

Answer: A. Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)

Q) As per recent information, Reserve Bank – Integrated Ombudsman Scheme, 2021 to be called as **‘रिज़र्व बैंक-एकीकृत ओम्बड्समैन योजना, 2021’** instead of **‘रिज़र्व बैंक-एकीकृत लोकपाल योजना, 2021’** after inputs from Lokpal of India. This scheme also includes under its ambit Non-Scheduled Primary Co-operative Banks with a deposit size of _____.

- A. Rs 100 crore and above
- B. Rs 150 crore and above
- C. Rs 200 crore and above
- D. Rs 50 crore and above



Answer: D. Rs 50 crore and above

Q) Recently, which of the following organisation and French Development Agency (Agence Française de Développement, AFD) has signed a **USD 100 million Credit Facility Agreement (CFA)** to enhance green finance solutions for India’s Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)?

- A. IFCI Ltd
- B. ECGC Limited
- C. Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)
- D. Export-Import Bank of India (Exim Bank)

Answer: C. Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)

Q) Recently, _____ has invested Rs 860 crore in **India’s 1st Sustainability-linked Bond (SLB) in the road sector**, issued by Cube Highways Trust (Cube InvIT (Infrastructure Investment Trust)).

- A. International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)
- B. New Development Bank (NDB)
- C. Asian Development Bank (ADB)
- D. International Finance Corporation (IFC)

Answer: D. International Finance Corporation (IFC)

Q) As per recent information, **Export Import Bank of India (EXIM Bank)** will provide lines of credit worth USD 300 million to which of the following countries for buying high-speed boats and offshore patrol vessels?

- A. Sri Lanka
- B. Thailand
- C. Vietnam
- D. Malaysia

Answer: C. Vietnam

Q) As per recently released **“Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) – Quarterly Bulletin [October – December 2024]”** by Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation, Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) in urban areas among persons of age 15 years and above has increased from 49.9% during October - December, 2023 to _____ in quarter October – December, 2024.

- A. 50.4%
- B. 53.7%
- C. 56.9%
- D. 59.2%

Answer: A. 50.4%

Q) Recently, which of the following companies has launched the **"One Man Office" (OMO)** service to provide its sales force with a comprehensive digital ecosystem, enabling them to serve policyholders seamlessly?

- A. SBI Life Insurance Co. Ltd.
- B. HDFC Life Insurance Co. Ltd.
- C. Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)
- D. Bajaj Allianz Life Insurance Co. Ltd.

Answer: C. Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)

Q) As per recently released “**India @2047: Transforming India into a Tech-Driven Economy**” report, India is set to transform into a high-income country with a projected GDP of \$23–\$35 trillion by 2047, driven by sustained annual growth of _____.

- A. 7-8%
C. 10-11%

- B. 8-10%
D. 11-13%



Answer: B. 8-10%

Q) Recently, Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has introduced _____, a new mobile application that provides seamless **access to macroeconomic and financial data** related to the Indian economy.

- A. RBIINFO
C. RBISeva

- B. RBISetu
D. RBIDATA

Answer: D. RBIDATA

Q) Recently, Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) has formed a high-powered committee to scrutinise various aspects of **Insurance Act 1938** and suggest amendments. Who among the following has been appointed as head of this committee?

- A. K. G. Ananthakrishnan
C. Dinesh Khara

- B. Vijay Srirangan
D. Challa Sreenivasulu Setty

Answer: C. Dinesh Khara

- The **seven-member panel** includes **NS Kannan**, former MD and CEO of ICICI Prudential Life Insurance; **Girish Radhakrishnan**, former CMD of United India Insurance; **Rakesh Joshi**, former member of Irda; **Saurabh Sinha**, former executive director of RBI; **Alok Misra**, MD and CEO of MFIN and legal expert **L Vishwanathan**.

Q) Recently, Forbes India has released its **5th Edition of “Top 10 Richest Women in the World in 2025” list**, highlighting the significant wealth amassed by women across different sectors. Who among the following has secured top position globally, as per this list?

- A. Françoise Bettencourt Meyers
C. Jacqueline Mars

- B. Alice Walton
D. Julia Margaret Flesher Koch

Answer: B. Alice Walton

Rank and Name	Net Worth	Source of Wealth
1. Alice Walton	\$112.5 billion	Walmart
2. Françoise Bettencourt Meyers and Family	\$74.4 billion	L'Oréal
3. Julia Koch and Family	\$74.2 billion	Koch Industries
4. Jacqueline Mars	\$42.3 billion	Mars Inc
5. Rafaela Aponte-Diamant	\$39.0 billion	Mediterranean Shipping Company (MSC) Group
6. Abigail Johnson	\$36.0 billion	Fidelity Investments
7. Savitri Jindal & family	\$32.3 billion	JSW Group
8. MacKenzie Scott	\$32.3 billion	Amazon
9. Miriam Adelson & family	\$31.5 billion	Las Vegas Sands
10. Marilyn Simons & family	\$31.0 billion	Hedge Funds

Q) Recently, government has extended the term of **Chief Economic Advisor (CEA)** _____ by two years till March 2027.

- A. V Anantha Nageswaran
C. Dr. Vijay Kumar Saraswat

- B. Suman K Bery
D. Prof. Ramesh Chand

Answer: A. V Anantha Nageswaran

Q) Recently, which of the following organisation has allowed a One-Time Mandate (OTM) on Unified Payments Interface (UPI) for insurance companies through a new payment mechanism called **Bima-Applications Supported by Blocked Amount (Bima-ASBA)**?

- A. New India Assurance Co. Ltd.
C. Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)
- B. Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA)
D. Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)

Answer: C. Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)

Q) As per recently released "**2024 Burgundy Private Hurun India 500 list**", which of the following companies has retained its position as India's most valuable company for the fourth consecutive year?

- A. HCL Technologies Limited
C. Reliance Industries Limited (RIL)
- B. Tata Consultancy Services Limited (TCS)
D. HDFC Bank Limited

Answer: C. Reliance Industries Limited (RIL)

Top 10 of 2024 Burgundy Private Hurun India 500

1-	Reliance Industries	17,52,650	12%	5%	Mumbai	Mukesh D. Ambani
2-	Tata Consultancy Services	16,10,800	30%	23%	Mumbai	Kunchitham Krithivasan
3-	HDFC Bank	14,22,570	26%	57%	Mumbai	Sashidhar Jagdishan
4↑	Bharti Airtel	9,74,470	75%	152%	New Delhi	Gopal Vittal
5↓	ICICI Bank	9,30,720	44%	73%	Mumbai	Sandeep Suraj Bakhshi
6↓	Infosys	7,99,400	40%	6%	Bengaluru	Salil Parekh
7-	ITC	5,80,670	8%	98%	Kolkata	Sanjiv Puri
8-	Larsen & Toubro	5,42,770	35%	366%	Mumbai	S. N. Subrahmanyam
9-	HCL Technologies	5,18,170	51%	62%	Noida	C Vijayakumar
10*	National Stock Exchange of India	4,70,250	201%	179%	Mumbai	Ashishkumar Chauhan

↑ Rank increase yoy ↓ Rank decrease yoy - No Rank change yoy * New to Top 10

Source: Hurun Research Institute, 2024 Burgundy Private Hurun India 500



Table 4: 2024 Burgundy Private Hurun India 500 Top 10 Unlisted Companies

Rank	Company	Value (INR Cr)	Value Change (%)	Headquarter	Key Leader
1↑	National Stock Exchange of India	4,70,250	201%	Mumbai	Ashishkumar Chauhan
2↓	Serum Institute of India	2,11,610	10%	Pune	Cyrus Poonawalla
3↑	Zoho Corporation	1,03,760	58%	Chennai	Sridhar Vembu
4↑	Zerodha	87,750	50%	Bengaluru	Nithin Kamath
5↓	Megha Engineering & Infrastructures	77,860	15%	Hyderabad	P.V. Krishna Reddy
6↑	Parle Products	68,640	16%	Mumbai	Vijay Kantilal Chauhan
7↓	Intas Pharmaceuticals	68,150	10%	Ahmedabad	Nimish Chudgar
8↓	Dream11	67,860	13%	Mumbai	Harsh Jain
9↑	Razorpay	63,620	11%	Bengaluru	Harshil Mathur
10*	Amalgamations	56,660	68%	Chennai	Ram Venkataramani

Q) Recently, **Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI)** has announced “the Chhoti SIP”, a _____ Systematic Investment Plan (SIP), designed to make mutual fund investing more accessible, particularly for first-time investors and those from underserved segments.

- A. Rs. 100
- C. Rs. 250

- B. Rs. 150
- D. Rs. 300



Answer: C. Rs. 250

Q) Recently, **State Bank of India (SBI)** Research report has estimated India’s GDP growth to come in at _____ in FY25, on the assumption that no major revision takes place for Q1 and Q2 growth figures released by National Statistical Office (NSO).

- A. 6.7%
- C. 6.5%

- B. 6.3%
- D. 7.1%

Answer: B. 6.3%

Real GDP Projections		
	SBI	NSO
Q1 FY25 (Actual)		6.7%
Q2 FY25 (Actual)		5.4%
Q3 FY25	6.2%-6.3%	-
Q4 FY25	Above 6.5%	-
FY25 P	6.3%	6.4%
Source: RBI; SBI Research		

Q) Recently, Reserve Bank of India has launched ‘**Financial Literacy Week 2025**’. This year, the campaign runs from _____, under the theme “Financial Literacy – Women’s Prosperity.

- A. February 22 to 26
- C. February 20 to 24

- B. February 24 to 28
- D. February 18 to 22

Answer: B. February 24 to 28

Q) Recently, National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) and Central Depository Services Limited (CDSL) has collaborated with which of the following organisation to launch a mobile application (app) **Unified Investor Platform (UIP)**, integrating CDSL’s MyEasi by NSDL’s SPEED-e?

- A. Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
- C. BSE Limited

- B. National Stock Exchange of India Ltd
- D. Reserve Bank of India

Answer: A. Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)

Q) Recently, which of the following companies has launched **India’s first solar-powered payment device**, designed for merchants to accept Unified Payments Interface (UPI) and RuPay Credit Card payments using a Quick-Response (QR) code?

- A. Dynamic
- C. Paytm Money Limited

- B. Mekk Technologies
- D. Bank of Baroda

Answer: C. Paytm Money Limited